
BUYER TIP 1
UNDER CONTRACT? PLAN THE CLOSE.
FROM CONTRACT TO KEYS
The weeks between an accepted offer and closing day shape how smoothly you move in. Here's how I recommend using them.
BUYER TIPS
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THE MARKET

CHARLOTTE RIGHT NOW

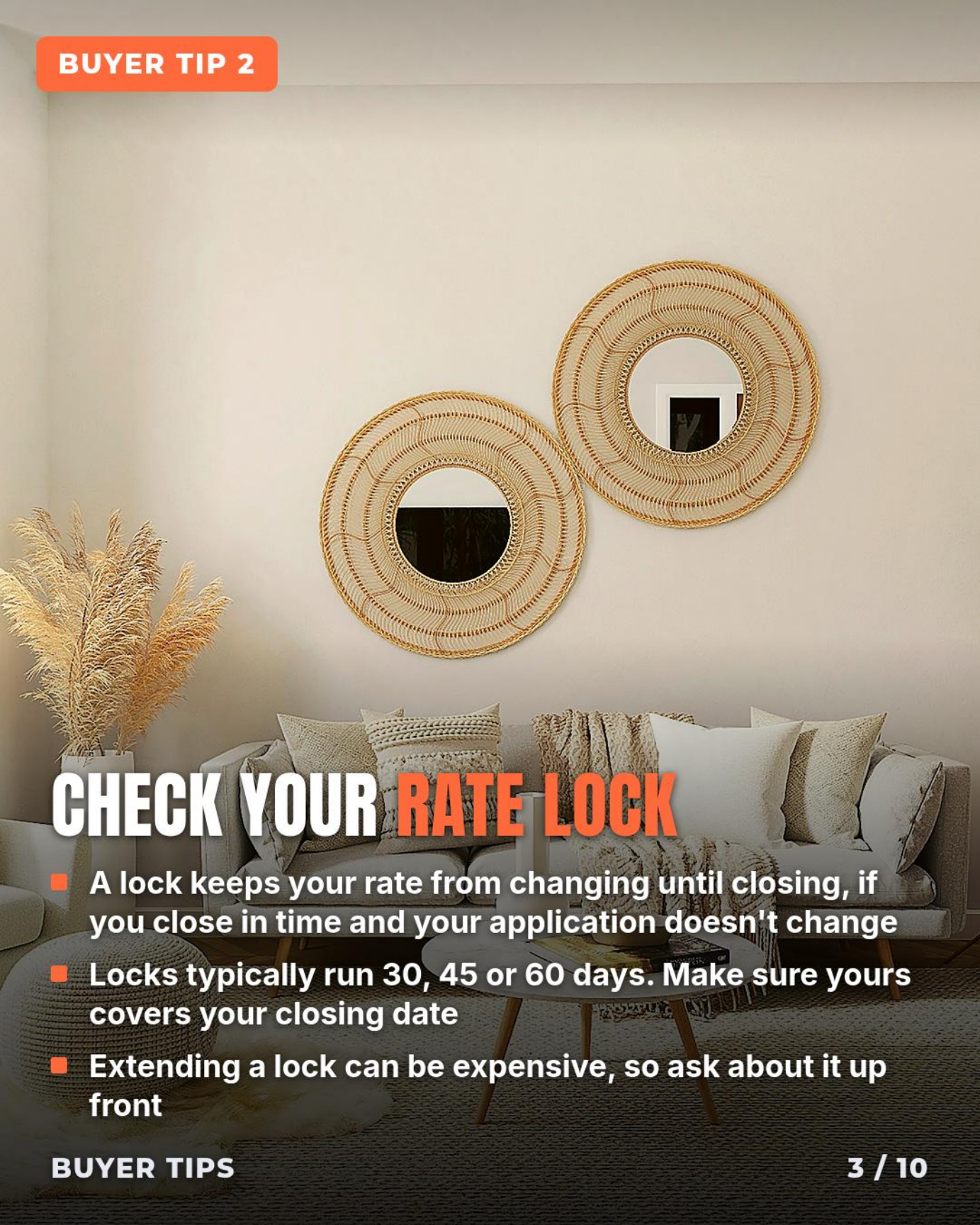
AS OF OCTOBER 2026

MEDIAN LIST	$421,450	
SALE-TO-LIST	99%	1.16% under ask
DAYS ON MKT	63	median
ACTIVE	6,000	+13.79% YoY

More homes to choose from than a year ago, and offers still land close to asking. Plan your closing as carefully as your offer.

Source: Realtor.com Economic Research, Charlotte, NC, Oct 2026

BUYER TIP 2



CHECK YOUR RATE LOCK

- A lock keeps your rate from changing until closing, if you close in time and your application doesn't change
- Locks typically run 30, 45 or 60 days. Make sure yours covers your closing date
- Extending a lock can be expensive, so ask about it up front

BUYER TIP 3



KEEP YOUR FINANCES STEADY

- Even a locked rate can change if your loan amount, credit score or verified income changes
- A new loan or a missed payment can move your credit score
- I recommend checking with your lender before any big purchase or job change

BUYER TIP 4



GET A COPY OF THE APPRAISAL

- On a first-lien mortgage, your lender must give you a free copy of every appraisal
- It's due promptly when it's done, or three business days before closing, whichever is earlier
- You may be asked to waive that timing. Think it over before you agree



BUYER TIP 5

LINE UP INSURANCE EARLY

- Lenders generally require proof of homeowner's insurance
- Standard policies don't cover flood or earthquake damage, though you may be able to add it
- You can shop for your own policy and compare it with your Loan Estimate

BUYER TIP 6



READ YOUR CLOSING DISCLOSURE

- Your lender must give it to you at least three business days before closing
- Compare it with your Loan Estimate: loan type, rate, monthly payment and fees
- By law, only certain costs can change. Ask about anything that did

BUYER TIP 7



VERIFY EVERY WIRE

- An email with last-minute changes to wire instructions may be a scam
- Confirm by phone with trusted contacts, using numbers you saved in advance
- Never use phone numbers or links from the email itself



BUYER TIP 8

GET READY FOR CLOSING DAY

- Bring your ID, your Closing Disclosure and your payment or proof of wire
- Take all the time you need to read every document
- NC: keys, codes and garage openers are delivered at Closing unless an agreement says otherwise (Form 2-T)

MY RECOMMENDATION



BUILD ONE CLOSING CALENDAR

I recommend putting your rate lock, appraisal, insurance and Closing Disclosure dates on one calendar the day you go under contract. Let's map yours together.

Denise Wilson | REALTOR®
denisewilson.lircarolinas.com
704-615-7347

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